

Travel Photography Guide

Locations · Poses · Solo / Partner / Group

BEST LOCATION TYPES & HOW TO SHOOT THEM

Urban Rooftops

- › Golden hour (1h after sunrise, 1h before sunset)
- › Use leading lines — fire escapes, ledges, railings
- › Shoot subject at edge, city soft-blurred behind

Ancient Ruins & Temples

- › Early morning = no crowds, golden light
- › Frame with arches and doorways
- › Silhouette pose works especially well here

Beaches & Coastline

- › Blue hour (just after sunset) for dreamy tones
- › Long exposure for silky water effect
- › Rule of thirds: horizon at top or bottom, not centre

Mountain Peaks

- › Midday light harsh — overcast day = perfect diffusion
- › Human in frame to show scale
- › Use foreground rocks / snow for depth

Markets & Street Scenes

- › High shutter speed for motion — freeze the chaos
- › Shoot at stall height, not eye-level
- › Candid > posed in busy environments

Forests & Nature

- › Backlight through trees: stand between sun and lens
- › Look down as well — ground textures, shadows, roots
- › Wide aperture (f/1.8–2.8) isolates subject beautifully

Travel Photography

Solo Poses · Partner Shots · The Art of Self-Direction

SOLO TRAVEL POSES THAT ALWAYS WORK

Walking Away

- › Back to camera, looking forward or at surroundings
- › Works at any location — city, nature, architecture

The Look-Up

- › Stand below landmark, look up with slight smile
- › Great for tall buildings, cathedrals, forests

Sitting + Thinking

- › Perched on ledge, steps, or wall — looking to side
- › Add a coffee, book, or map as a prop

Mid-Motion

- › Walking, spinning, fixing hair — caught mid-action
- › Feels authentic; avoid over-staged poses

Silhouette

- › Stand against sunset/window light, full profile
- › Works even with no photographer skill required

SELF-TIMER & SOLO SHOOT TIPS

- ♦ Use a mini tripod + Bluetooth remote — €15 total
- ♦ Burst mode × 10 shots: pick the best one
- ♦ Pre-focus: tape or bottle at exact spot you'll stand
- ♦ Natural framing (doorway, tree gap) hides tripod perfectly

Travel Photography

Partner & Group — Candid, Composed & Everything Between

PARTNER & COUPLE SHOTS

The Walk Together

- › Side by side from behind — hands linked or swinging
- › Shoot wide to include surroundings, not just people

Forehead Touch

- › Faces close, eyes closed or smiling — intimate and timeless
- › Works in any light; use portrait mode

Lead + Follow

- › One person looks back, other walks ahead
- › Creates story and movement in a still frame

Reading the Map

- › Leaning over something together — map, menu, guidebook
- › Feels genuine; works in cafés, streets, markets

The Candid Laugh

- › Tell a joke just before the shot — real laughter only
- › Ask photographer to shoot before 'ready' — authentic

GROUP TRAVEL PHOTOGRAPHY

Staggered Levels

- › Different heights — steps, ledges, crouching, standing
- › Avoids the flat 'school photo' look instantly

Action Shot

- › All jumping, running, high-fiving — ask for 3-2-1 burst
- › One candid per location, rest posed — variety matters

Looking In, Not Out

- › All looking at same thing: a view, menu, a map
- › Natural group eye direction creates visual unity

The Golden Rule of Travel Photography

The best photo isn't the most posed — it's the most present.

Put the phone down for 10 minutes. Then take 3 intentional shots.